

three journals produce more Top 1% articles than *JPE*, and the remaining one produces as many Top 1% articles as the *JPE*. *ReStud* is outranked by six additional non-survey non-T5 journals. These journals contribute a further 16% to the Top 1% bin. The contributions of non-T5 non-survey journals remains significant across the remaining three citation bins. The five most influential non-survey journals in the Top 5% bin produce a combined 20% of the articles in that bin. The Top 10% and Top 25% bins receive 19% and 24% of their publications respectively from the five most influential non-T5 sources within their respective bins.

The discussion thus far focuses on each journal’s absolute production of influential articles. *AER* publishes at least twice as many papers as the next highest T5 journal. It is informative to compare contributions in light of each journal’s total volume of publications. Table 3 produces a publication volume-adjusted version of the rankings presented in Table 2.⁶² The adjustment discounts the contribution of high-volume journals such as *AER* in order to account for the increased probability of contribution (to the citation bins) associated with publishing a larger volume of articles.

The volume adjustment leads to a substantial reordering of journals within all of the citation bins. The *AER* falls in the rankings from first or third place in the unadjusted ranking (depending on the citation bin) to the third place or lower in the adjusted ranking. The adjustment increases the relative contributions from the *QJE* and *JPE*, reflecting the fact that these journals have a lower volume of publication than the *AER*. While the increase in their proportions improves the overall standing of these two journals, it does not result in

⁶²The rankings are based on volume-adjusted proportions of contributions to each citation bin, where the adjusted proportion for journal- j in citation bin b is computed as follows:

$$P_{j,b} = \frac{1}{N_b} \sum_{y=2000}^{2010} C_{j,y,b} / \left(\frac{v_{j,y}}{V_y} \right) \quad (2)$$

where N_b is the total number of articles in citation bin b , $C_{j,y,b}$ is the count of all articles published by journal- j during year y that received enough citations to be included in citation bin b , $v_{j,y}$ is the number of articles published by journal j during year y , and V_y is the total number of articles published in year y by all of the 30 economics journals included in this exercise. The term $(v_{j,y}/V_y)$ is a year-specific volume adjustment that weights the contribution of each journal by the inverse of its publication volume during a given year.

Table 3: Publication Volume-Adjusted Proportion of Influential Articles Published By Individual Journals Between 2000–2010

Rank	Top 25% Citations N=3321		Top 10% Citations N=1329		Top 5% Citations N=665		Top 1% Citations N=133	
1.	QJE	(12.0%)	QJE	(16.6%)	JEL	(19.8%)	JEL	(26.6%)
2.	JEL	(8.9%)	JEL	(14.2%)	QJE	(17.8%)	QJE	(18.0%)
3.	AER	(7.8%)	AER	(8.6%)	JEP	(8.8%)	JEG	(11.8%)
4.	JPE	(7.3%)	JPE	(8.3%)	AER	(8.7%)	JEP	(7.8%)
5.	JEP	(6.9%)	JEP	(7.5%)	JPE	(6.0%)	ECMA	(5.5%)
6.	ECMA	(5.7%)	ECMA	(5.9%)	ECMA	(5.2%)	AER	(5.5%)
7.	JEG	(4.6%)	JEG	(5.3%)	JEG	(5.0%)	JPE	(3.5%)
8.	ReStud	(4.6%)	ReStud	(4.1%)	ReStat	(3.5%)	ReStat	(2.8%)
9.	ReStat	(3.9%)	ICC	(3.8%)	ICC	(3.0%)	RAND	(2.7%)
10.	JOLE	(3.6%)	ReStat	(3.4%)	ReStud	(3.0%)	JBES	(2.6%)
11.	ICC	(3.4%)	EJ	(2.7%)	EJ	(2.6%)	JHE	(2.0%)
12.	WBER	(3.4%)	WBER	(2.5%)	WBER	(2.3%)	JOE	(2.0%)
13.	EJ	(3.4%)	JOLE	(2.3%)	JOE	(2.1%)	ICC	(1.9%)
14.	JHR	(3.2%)	JOE	(1.9%)	JOLE	(1.8%)	EJ	(1.7%)
15.	JDE	(2.8%)	JDE	(1.9%)	JME	(1.6%)	WBER	(1.4%)
16.	JHE	(2.5%)	JHE	(1.6%)	JHE	(1.4%)	ReStud	(1.3%)
17.	RAND	(2.5%)	JME	(1.5%)	JBES	(1.3%)	JPub	(1.2%)
18.	JOE	(2.4%)	JPub	(1.5%)	RAND	(1.3%)	JOLE	(1.2%)
19.	JME	(2.4%)	JBES	(1.2%)	JPub	(1.1%)	JME	(0.6%)
20.	JPub	(2.3%)	RAND	(1.2%)	JHR	(1.0%)	JEEA	(0.0%)

Source: Scopus.com; accessed 07/2018

Note: This table presents publication volume-adjusted proportions of highly cited articles published by different journals. Adjusted proportions are calculated according to Equation 2.

Definition of journal abbreviations: QJE–Quarterly Journal Of Economics, JPE–Journal Of Political Economy, ECMA–Econometrica, AER–American Economic Review, ReStud–Review Of Economic Studies, JEL–Journal Of Economic Literature, JEP–Journal Of Economic Perspectives, ReStat–Review Of Economics And Statistics, JEG–Journal Of Economic Growth, JOLE–Journal Of Labor Economics, JHR–Journal Of Human Resources, EJ–Economic Journal, JHE–Journal Of Health Economics, ICC–Industrial And Corporate Change, WBER–World Bank Economic Review, RAND–Rand Journal Of Economics, JDE–Journal Of Development Economics, JPub–Journal Of Public Economics, JOE–Journal Of Econometrics, JHE–Health Economics, ILR–Industrial And Labor Relations Review, JEEA–Journal Of The European Economic Association, JME–Journal Of Monetary Economics, JRU–Journal Of Risk And Uncertainty, JInE–Journal Of Industrial Economics, JOF–Journal Of Finance, JFE–Journal Of Financial Economics, ReFin–Review Of Financial Studies, JFQA–Journal Of Financial And Quantitative Analysis, and MathFin–Mathematical Finance.

improvements in rankings across all bins since other journals such as the *JEL* get even larger increases in their proportion of contributions. *ECMA* experiences a negative adjustment and falls to sixth place in the Top 25%, Top 10%, and Top 5% bins. *ReStud* shows ranking improvements in the Top 25% and Top 10% bins. However, its rankings are not affected in the Top 5% and Top 1% bins despite the volume adjustment.

Among non-T5 non-survey journals, *JEG* has the largest upward shift, consistently

ranking within the Top 7 across all citation bins. *ReStat* falls in rank. However, it continues to remain influential across the various citation bins. *EJ* and *JOE* both move down the scale.

The major takeaway from the rankings in Tables 1 and 2 is that non-T5 non-survey journals publish a significant volume of influential research in economics, frequently outperforming some of the less-influential T5 journals. Their influence on the discipline is highly visible regardless of whether one considers their absolute volume of contributions or contributions per unit of publication.

4.3 The T5 are Not the Journals with the Top Five Impact Factors in Economics

Table 4 presents impact factors by lag (2 year; 5 year; ...; 20 year) with the longest lag showing the lasting contributions (citations at 20 years). Among the T5, only the *QJE* is in the T5 impact in any listed year, and is ranked first at all lags except the 10 year lag. Finance journals have much higher impact factors, reflecting the scale of practitioners in that field. Journals with high short-term (2 year) impacts often do not keep their rankings over the long term. The very basis for the ranking of the T5 – that it signals journals with the most cited papers – is flawed. Only the *QJE* deserves that status.

The scale of the impact of economics journals pales into insignificance compared to that of science journals (see Online Appendix Table O-A34). The two year impact factors for any of the six leading journals listed in that table exceed those of any economics journal. *Science* is ranked fourth with two and five-year impact factors around 41. Also notable is the *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences* – an outlet in which many important papers by economists have appeared, but which is off the table in T5 assessments. Its impact factor rivals the highest ranked journal economics impact factor.

Table 4: 2, 5, 10, 15, and 20 Year Impact Factors For 25 Economics Journals Constructed Using Citations Data From 2017, Ordered by 5 Year Impact Factor

	2 Year IF		5 Year IF		10 Year IF		15 Year IF		20 Year IF	
	Rank	IF	Rank	IF	Rank	IF	Rank	IF	Rank	IF
1. Quarterly Journal Of Economics	1	(8.57)	1	(12.80)	2	(15.53)	1	(18.62)	1	(20.11)
2. Journal Of Economic Perspectives	2	(7.21)	2	(10.82)	4	(11.52)	4	(11.91)	5	(11.03)
3. Journal Of Economic Literature	11	(4.29)	3	(9.91)	1	(17.24)	2	(17.13)	2	(18.60)
4. Journal Of Finance	5	(5.54)	4	(9.38)	3	(11.98)	3	(13.99)	3	(15.04)
5. Journal Of Financial Economics	6	(5.53)	5	(8.11)	5	(10.54)	5	(11.53)	4	(11.97)
6. American Economic Review	9	(4.63)	6	(6.53)	9	(7.41)	10	(8.04)	9	(8.25)
7. Review Of Financial Studies	10	(4.45)	7	(6.27)	6	(9.39)	7	(9.49)	8	(9.32)
8. Journal Of Economic Growth	4	(6.17)	8	(6.15)	12	(6.07)	9	(8.93)	10	(8.23)
9. Journal Of Political Economy	8	(5.08)	9	(6.09)	7	(8.48)	6	(10.09)	6	(10.75)
10. American Economic Journal: Applied Economics	7	(5.42)	10	(6.08)	.	(.)	.	(.)	.	(.)
11. Review Of Economic Studies	20	(3.12)	11	(6.03)	11	(6.42)	12	(7.00)	12	(7.14)
12. Econometrica	14	(3.87)	12	(5.94)	8	(7.86)	8	(9.25)	7	(9.69)
13. Review Of Economics And Statistics	15	(3.64)	13	(5.55)	10	(6.81)	11	(7.62)	11	(7.31)
14. American Economic Journal: Economic Policy	12	(3.99)	14	(5.51)	.	(.)	.	(.)	.	(.)
15. Journal Of Human Resources	3	(6.86)	15	(5.11)	13	(5.89)	15	(5.33)	15	(4.90)
16. American Economic Journal: Macroeconomics	17	(3.45)	16	(4.83)	.	(.)	.	(.)	.	(.)
17. Journal Of The European Economic Association	21	(3.04)	17	(4.70)	17	(4.82)	.	(.)	.	(.)
18. Journal Of Labor Economics	13	(3.88)	18	(4.62)	14	(5.14)	14	(5.33)	13	(5.21)
19. Economic Journal	19	(3.27)	19	(4.27)	15	(5.01)	13	(5.41)	14	(5.11)
20. Journal Of Health Economics	16	(3.49)	20	(4.00)	18	(4.32)	19	(4.50)	22	(4.45)
21. Journal Of Development Economics	23	(2.48)	21	(3.89)	16	(4.90)	16	(4.90)	20	(4.53)
22. Journal Of Monetary Economics	26	(2.24)	22	(3.27)	25	(3.51)	25	(3.86)	26	(3.83)
23. Journal Of Financial And Quantitative Analysis	27	(2.22)	23	(3.23)	19	(4.25)	18	(4.60)	16	(4.63)
24. Journal Of Applied Econometrics	24	(2.46)	24	(3.16)	23	(3.83)	23	(4.15)	17	(4.59)
25. Industrial And Corporate Change	25	(2.35)	25	(3.08)	22	(3.91)	20	(4.47)	19	(4.58)

Source: Scopus; Accessed 07/2018.

Note: This table presents 2, 5, 10, 15, and 20 Year Impact Factors for 51 different journals. Impact Factors are calculated using citations accrued during the year 2017. The table also presents five different journal rankings corresponding to each of the five Impact Factors. Due to data unavailability, we exclude the *AEJs* from the 10, 15, and 20 year Impact Factor calculations and rankings. We also exclude *JEEA* from the 15 and 20 Year Impact Factor calculations and rankings.

Definition of Impact Factor: For any given journal, an x -year Impact Factor as of 2017 is defined as the sum of citations received in 2017 by all articles published in the journal during the time period 2016- x to 2016 divided by the journal's total volume of publications during the same time period:

$$IF_{x,j}^{2017} = \sum_{y=2016-x}^{2016} \frac{\text{citations}_{y,j}^{2017}}{\text{volume}_j}$$

where $\text{citations}_{y,j}^{2017}$ represents the sum of citations received in 2017 by all articles published by journal- j during year y , and volume_j represents journal- j 's total volume of publication during the period 2016- x to 2016.

4.4 Where Influential Economists Publish

This section explores where influential economists publish classified by their field of specialization. We use RePEc's field-specific author rankings to compile a list of the 50 most influential authors⁶³ within 14 fields of specialization⁶⁴. We analyze their publication his-

⁶³Online Appendix Tables O-A43–O-A46 present the list of top 50 authors within each field. The fields of Finance and Industrial Organization include fewer than 50 authors because RePEc's ranking for these fields included fewer than 50 authors.

⁶⁴The fields include demographic economics, development economics, econometrics, environmental economics, experimental economics, finance, health economics, international finance, international trade, industrial organization, labor economics, macroeconomics, microeconomics, and public economics

tories to identify the journals that account for the largest share of publications by the T50 authors of each field.

We use *EconLit* to obtain lists of articles published by each author between 1996–2017. We use the classification scheme of [Card and DellaVigna \(2013\)](#) to assign articles to different fields based on JEL codes included in the *EconLit* data⁶⁵. The assignment yields 14 different publication lists corresponding to the 14 field-specific author groupings, where each publication list is restricted to only include journal articles that were identified as being related to the author’s field of specialization.

Online Appendix Table [O-A40](#) presents publication-volume-unadjusted field-specific journal rankings based on the share of field f -specific articles written by field f ’s T50 authors that was published in each journal j . The table presents rankings for the ten journals that accounted for the largest share of publications. The rankings show that the top authors in each field publish the largest volume of their field-specific publications in either the *AER* or in non-T5 specialist field journals. The remaining four T5 journals do not feature in the top 3 for any field, except *ECMA* which ranks 3rd in econometrics and microeconomics. These patterns reveal that the foremost economists working in the major fields of specialization within economics publish most of their articles in non-T5 field journals.

The importance of non-T5 field journals becomes even more pronounced when we rank journals by publication shares that have been adjusted for inter-journal differences in volume of publication.⁶⁶ The publication volume-adjusted rankings in Table [5](#) show

⁶⁵We make the following changes to [Card and DellaVigna \(2013\)](#)’s classification scheme: (i) We break out the labor economics category into labor (*JEL* Codes I2 and J except J1), and demographic economics (*JEL* Codes J1); (ii) environmental economics is added as a field (*JEL* Code Q5); (iii) international economics is broken out into international finance (*JEL* Codes F3, F4, and F65) and international trade (*JEL* Codes F1 and F4); and (iv) urban economics is removed from the health and urban economics category to yield a health-only category (*JEL* Code I0 and I1). The rest of the fields are classified identically to [Card and DellaVigna \(2013\)](#).

⁶⁶Table [5](#) presents weighted rankings based on a field f -specific volume-adjusted proportion, $\tilde{S}_j^f$:

$$\tilde{S}_j^f = \frac{1}{N^f} \sum_{y=1996}^{2017} C_{j,y}^f / \left(\frac{v_{j,y}}{V_y} \right) \quad (3)$$